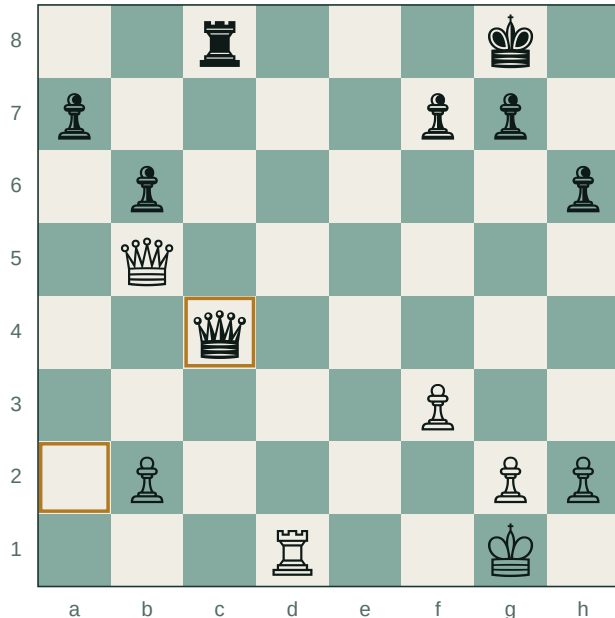


Deflection tactics: White, move 31

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 30...Qc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Rd8+ Rxd8 32. Qxc4 Rd1+ 33. Kf2

31.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d8 it attacks king on g8 and rook on c8. Recorded reply: **31...Rxd8**.

32.Qxc4 The queen captures the queen on c4. Recorded reply: **32...Rd1+**.

33.Kf2 The king moves from g1 to f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.